The Naked Card

What suits her best?

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The Naked Card is an interactive installation about self-discovery through play.

A blank playing card has fallen in a dark, floating world. She has lost her suit and can’t remember who she is. In front of her stands a giant Eye guarding a mysterious box filled with the suits it has taken from other cards. To escape, she must discover which one once belonged to her — with the help of the visitor.

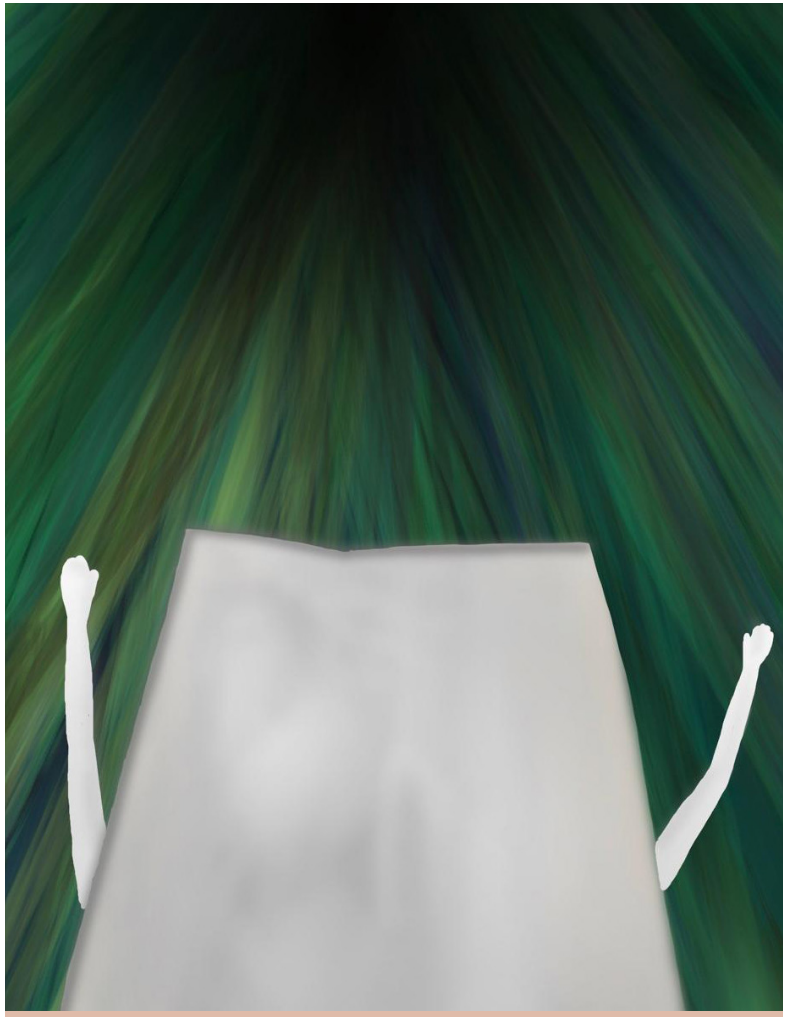
Visitors step into a spotlight projected on the floor and face a screen. From the box in front of them, they pick a suit symbol and hold it up. Each suit triggers a different mini-game, where players use their hands and gestures to help the card.

At the start of each game, the card tries on the chosen suit, and the player discovers a fun fact about its world through playful action.

Some suits feel wrong, others amusing — until the one that truly fits appears. When she finally recognises herself, the card glows with joy and breaks free from the Eye’s world.

The Card is transported through a tunnel each time we choose a suit symbol.

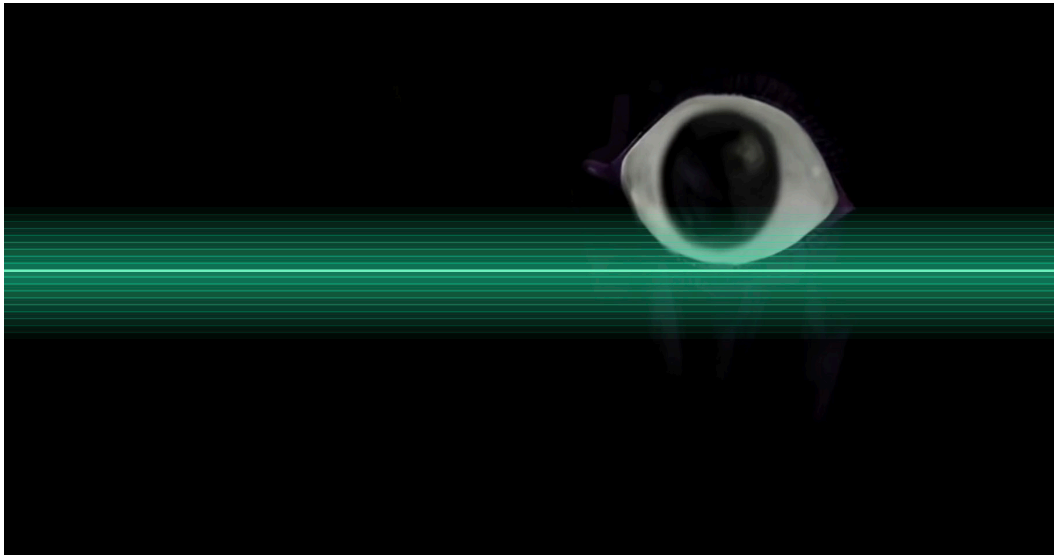
The Card meets the Eye and discovers the suits in a box.



The Interface - Key visuals

Mini-game triggered
by the baton suit.

Instructions
for the player.



The eye
waiting to scan
a suit symbol.

User Journey

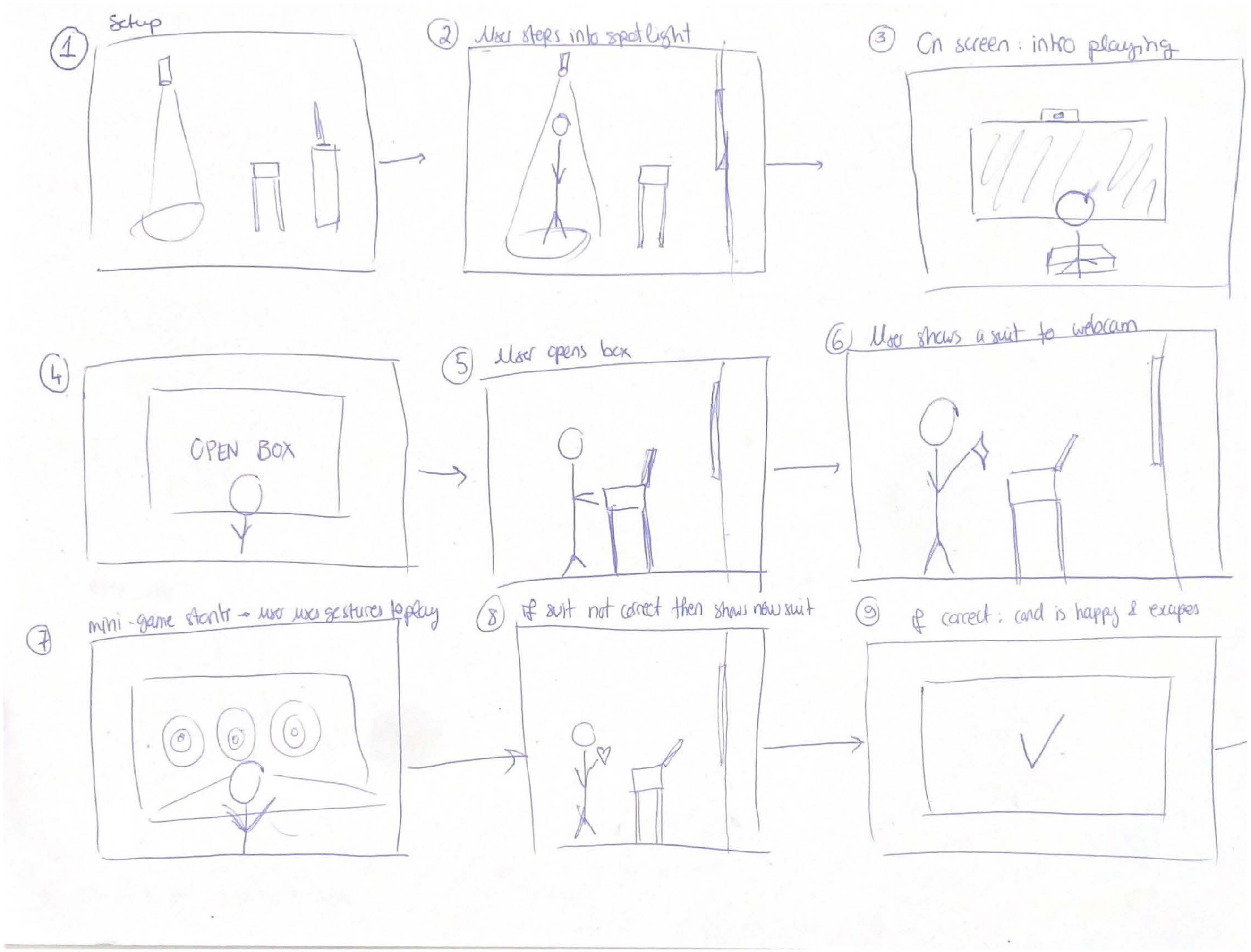
The installation begins with a still image on the screen: a dim cave, a blank card barely visible in the shadows. When a visitor steps into the circle of light on the floor, a matching beam of light appears on the screen. It lands on the card, who suddenly screams — embarrassed to be caught naked in the spotlight. She describes her surroundings: a large shape high above her with its eye still closed, and a box beneath it. Too scared to approach it herself, she asks the visitor to open the box for her.

1. The visitor opens the physical box and chooses one of the suit tokens.
2. They hold it up to the camera; the Eye scans the choice.
3. A mini-game inspired by a fun fact from the chosen suit begins. The user uses gestures to play.
4. The visitor repeats the process with different suits until the one that truly belongs to the card is found.
5. When the right suit appears, the card glows with joy and the story comes to an end.

Mini-games

– Batons: search for the missing 3 of Batons by waving to move scattered cards on screen.
– Coins: move hand up/down to spin a slot machine and align three identical coins.
– Diamonds: open fist to shoot arrows and close it to reload; hit five arbalette-shaped targets.
– Hearts: “draw” over a stencil using hand tracing to add colour to heart-shaped cards.

Additional games will be developed for the other eight suits: Spades, Bells, Clubs, Swords, Cups, Acorn, Leaves, and Shields.



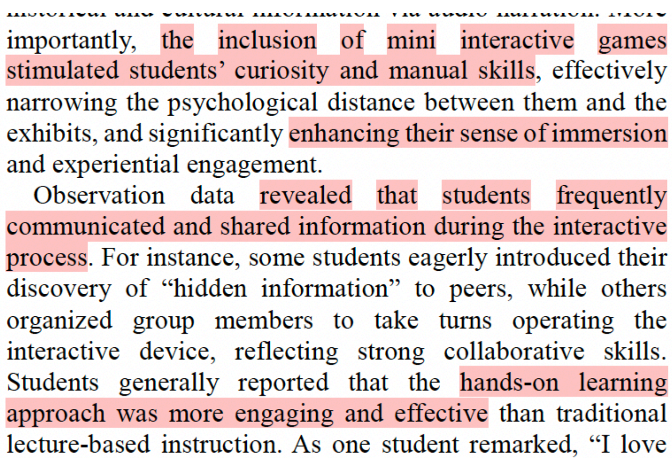
Research

Before becoming a team, we each explored very different entry points into the world of playing cards. One of us researched why people play card games, collecting memories, emotions and nostalgia linked to family games. The other investigated how children and families interact with phygital installations.

When merging our ideas, we identified several themes that consistently appeared across both research paths:

1. Cards as personal heritage objects, tied to memories and identity
2. The need for simple physical triggers (objects, drawers, spotlights) that make visitors feel in control
3. The importance of playful discovery for children
4. Short, curated pieces of card history, delivered through experience rather than lecture

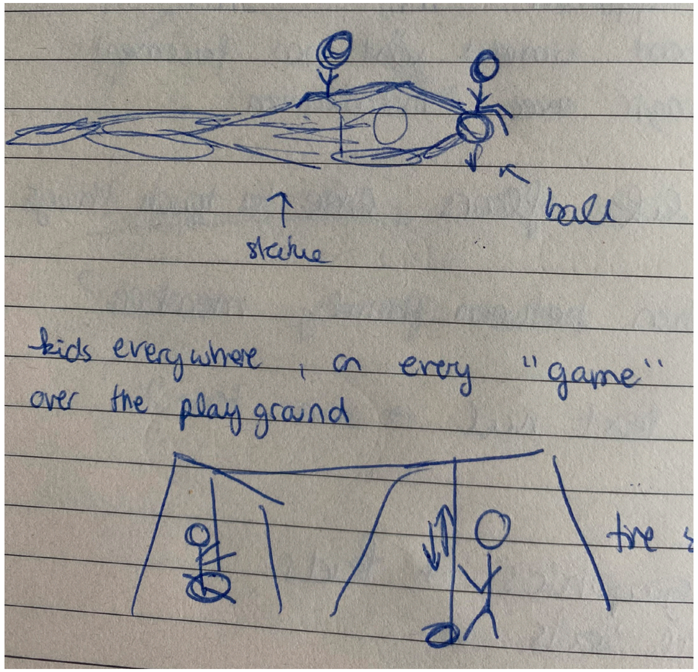
These themes shaped the evolution of our concept. Early prototypes explored wardrobes, court characters, and multi-story "card worlds," but user observations showed that users responded best when the goal was singular, emotional, and easy to follow.
This led to the final direction: a blank card who has lost her suit and needs help to remember it.



importantly, the inclusion of mini interactive games stimulated students' curiosity and manual skills, effectively narrowing the psychological distance between them and the exhibits, and significantly enhancing their sense of immersion and experiential engagement.

Observation data revealed that students frequently communicated and shared information during the interactive process. For instance, some students eagerly introduced their discovery of "hidden information" to peers, while others organized group members to take turns operating the interactive device, reflecting strong collaborative skills. Students generally reported that the hands-on learning approach was more engaging and effective than traditional lecture-based instruction. As one student remarked, "I love

An extract from Children's Learning Experiences in Immersive Museum Art Education: An Observational Case Study



Field observation of kids playing with statues and on the playground.

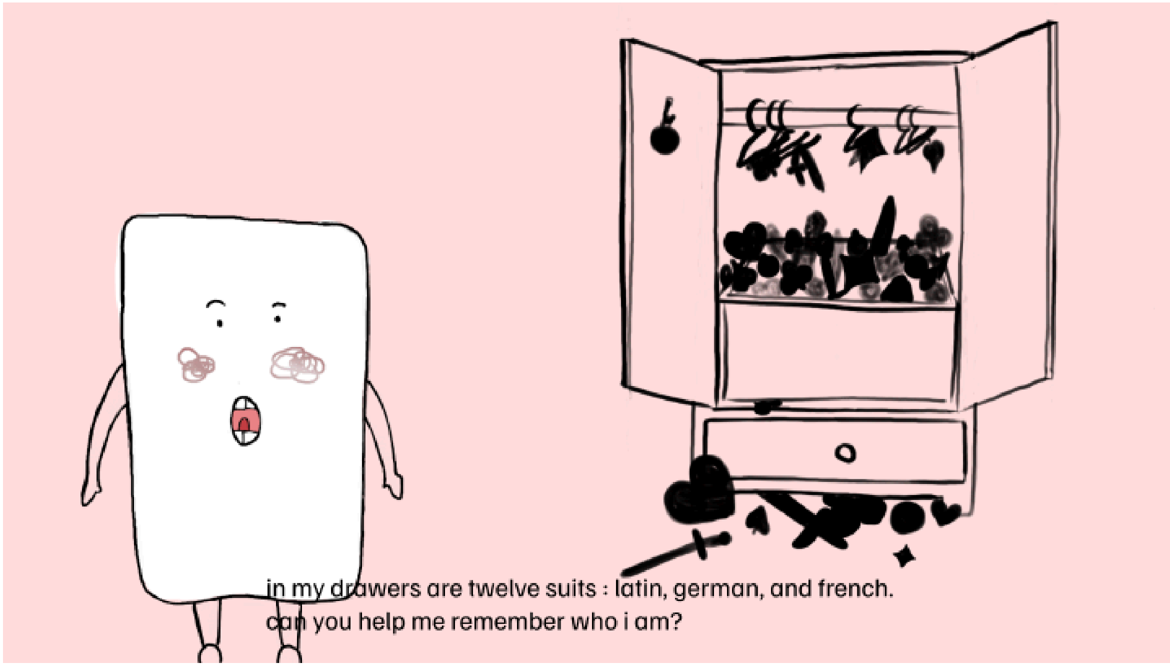
Ariadne Melissargos | Lisa Giraud
Team BlaBla | The Naked Card

Project Iterations

Our first idea placed the card in her bedroom, searching through a chaotic wardrobe of world suits. Although playful, this version lacked a strong narrative reason for why she was lost.

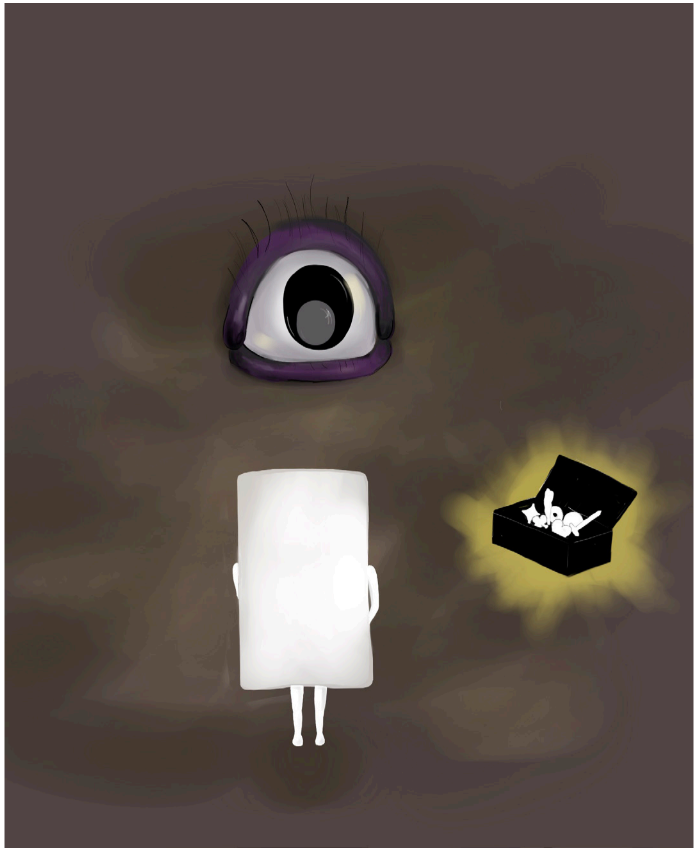
The concept became stronger when we imagined the card falling into a strange, dark world. This gave her confusion a concrete cause and created a clear role for the visitor. Introducing the giant Eye and the mysterious box gave the story purpose, tension, and a setting that fully embraced the fantasy.

The final version keeps only what supports the core idea: the card has lost her suit, is trapped in an unfamiliar place, and needs the visitor's help to find herself again.

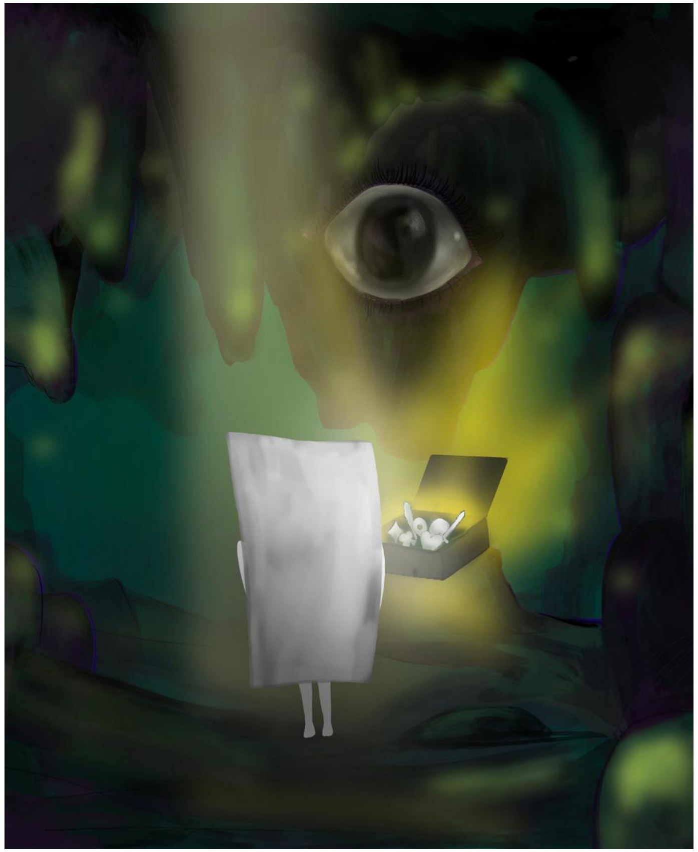


Early prototype, the card searched for suits in her wardrobe.

2nd prototype, the card is in a hole with the eye, the suits are in a box.



Latest prototype, the card is in a cave with the eye, the suits are in a box.



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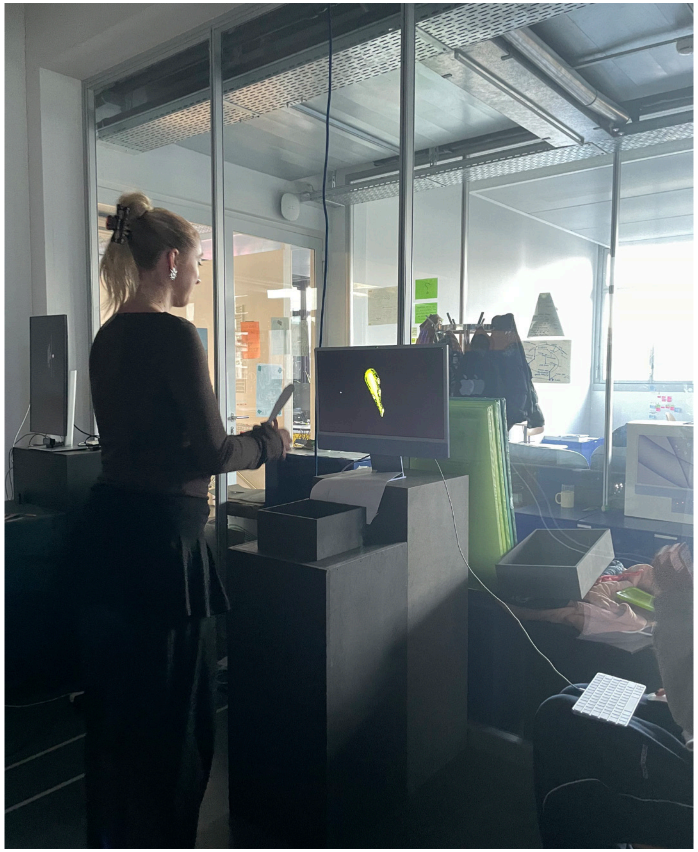
User Tests

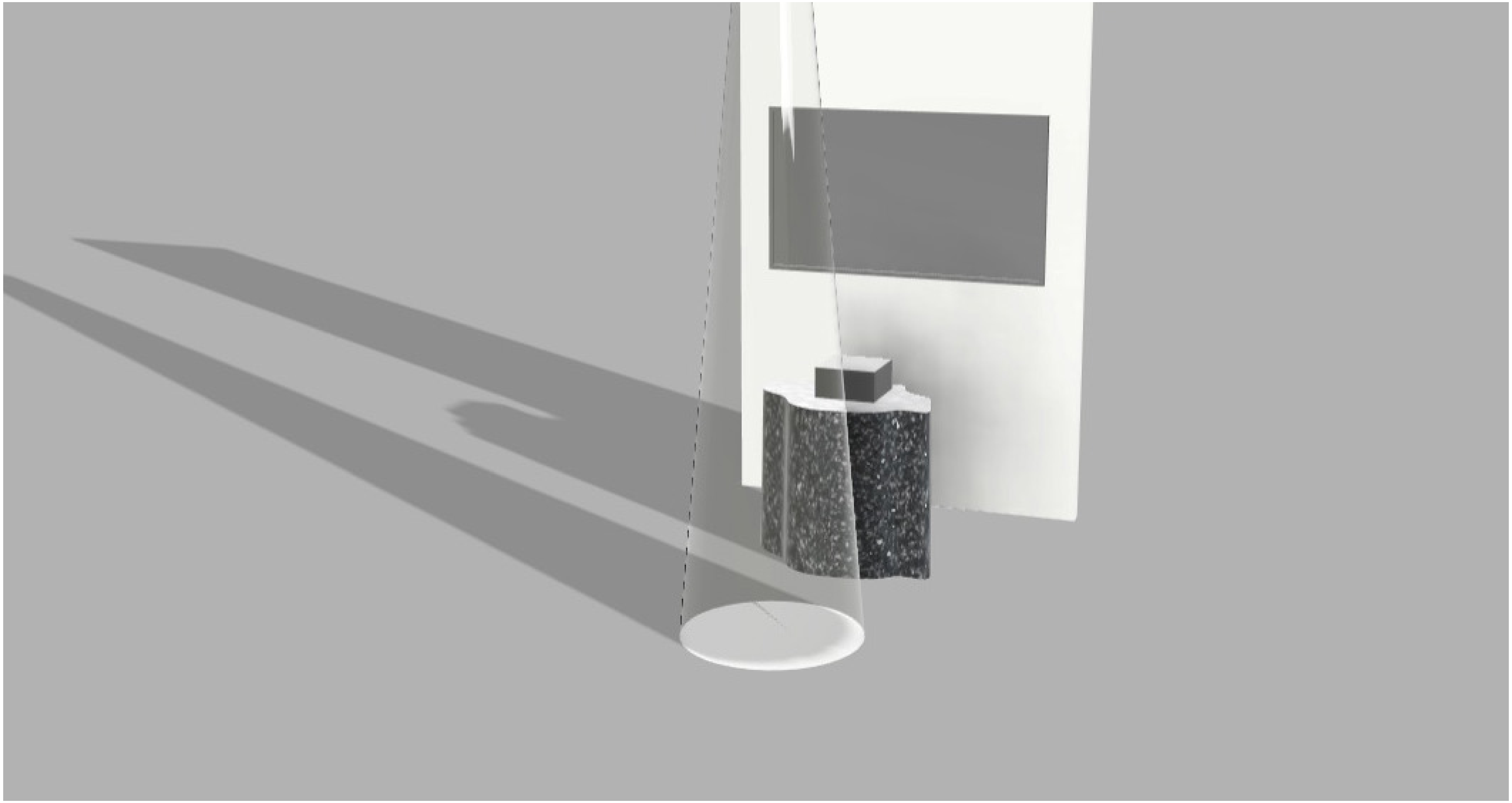
Distance
Visitors instinctively leaned too close to the computer and camera when showing the tokens and playing the games. To fix this, we moved the physical box further away, creating a natural distance.

Narrative clarity
Early testers were unsure why the card needed help. Adding the scream, the spotlight moment, and the Eye's brief explanations helped anchor the story and made the visitor's role feel purposeful.

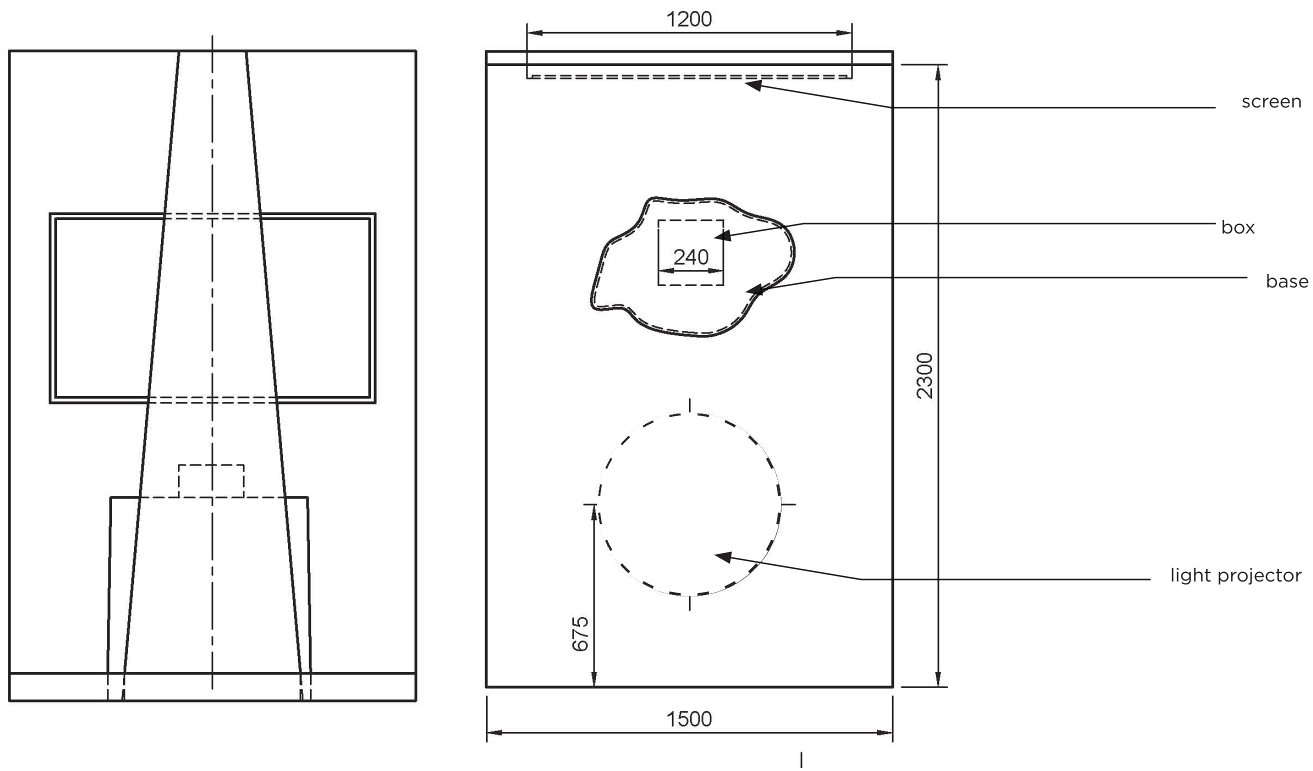
Gesture controls
Simple, single-action gestures (wave, trace, open/close hand) were understood quickly. More complex motions caused hesitation. We redesigned the mini-games to keep gestures intuitive and readable by the camera.



Scenography



Spatial diagram



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Technical diagram

Projection & Display
1 TV Screen
1 HDMI cable
1 Computer
1 USB-C to HDMI adapter or multiport hub (if needed)

Audio
2 or 1 powered speaker(s)
1 audio jack cable

Lighting & Tracking
1 floor spotlight or mini projector creating the light circle on the ground
1 external USB webcam (1080p) directed at visitor and box
1 USB extension cable

Power & Connectivity
1 multi-socket power strip
Power cables for all devices
Extension cords as required